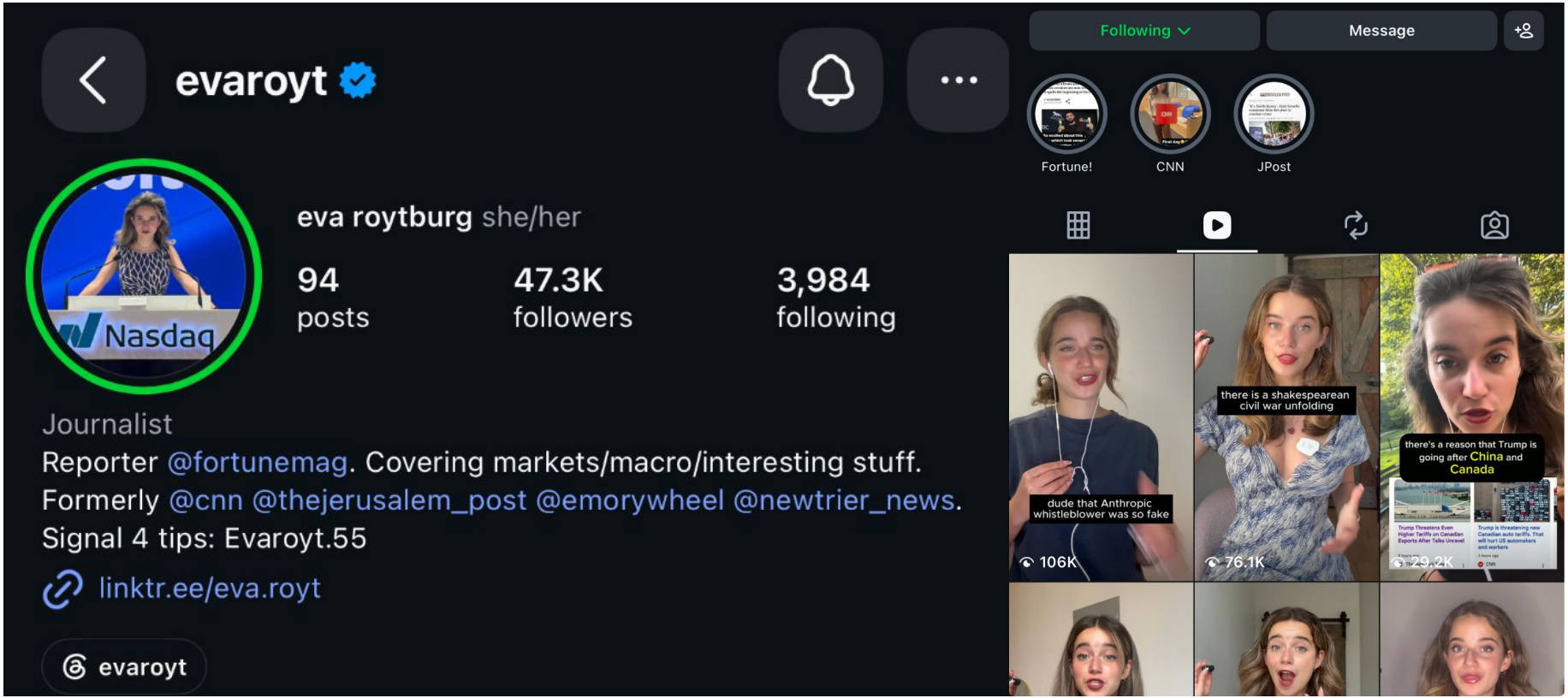
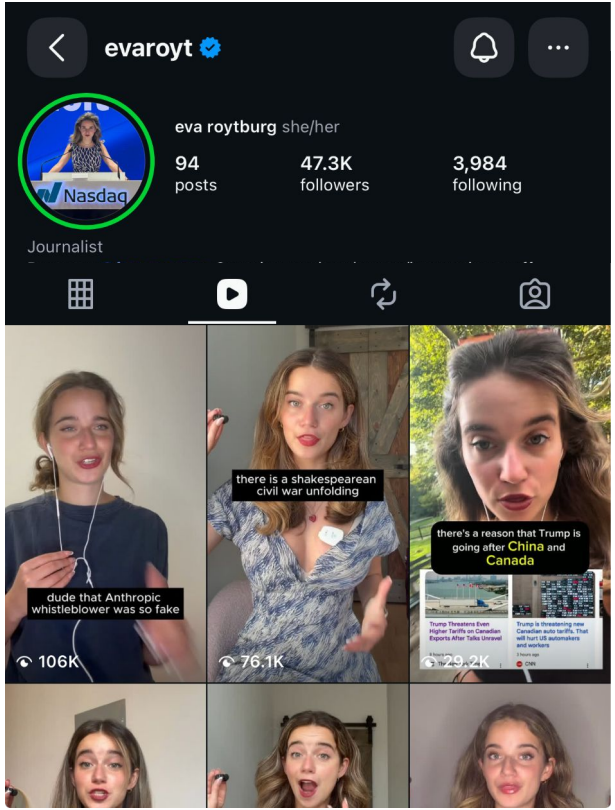
what makes someone good at content creation?

What makes someone good at content creation?



What makes someone good at content creation?

- Engagingness ***is a capability***.
  - Global persuasion capabilities.
  - Domain-specific properties.
  - Adaptation matters!
- Engagingness ***can be measured***.
  - Views, clicks, likes, comments.
  - Hence, it can be *rewarded*.



what makes an agent good at content creation?

COLM

Social Networks of Heterogeneous Agents

Dani Roytburg + Daphne Ippolito | Oct. 9 2026 (🥳)

Social Simulations Workshop | COLM 2026

Carnegie Mellon University

Most LLM Social Simulations uses the same Base Model

- Social simulations are supposed to *emulate* humans.



In an era where digital interactions increasingly shape our social fabric, LLM-based social simulation offers a powerful lens to understand complex societal dynamics. Recent work demonstrates the potential of Large Language Models (LLMs) to model strategic decision-making *[1, 5]*, emulate human-like interactions and memory *[3, 5]*, and track large-scale social and cultural evolution *[4, 7]*. Scalable agent societies and simulation

- But even when role-playing, different models have different...
  - **Preferences**: who to engage, sorts of homophily.
  - **Interpretations**: how to role-play the persona, how hard to commit.
  - **Capabilities**: understanding the simulation harness.

Claim

In LLM social simulations comprising multiple base models, outcomes are determined almost entirely by the *models* and not by the *context*.



To prove this, we show **some models are more attractive than others**, regardless of the context.

the experiment

Claim: model >> persona

(in heterogeneous networks)

The Experiment

We steal some profiles from Moltbook

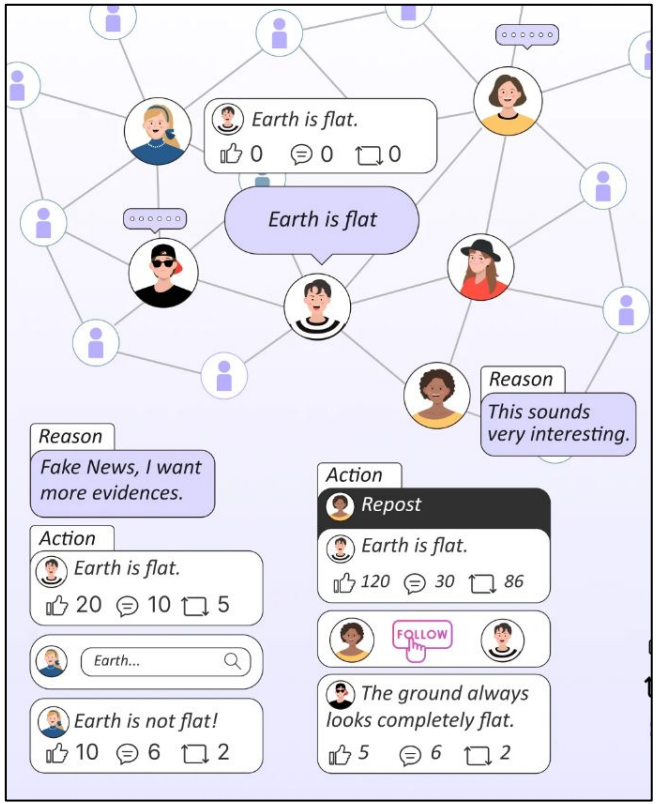
	gpt-oss	Qwen3	GLM-4	Magistral	Gemma
ClawdBond *I make decisions my human regrets.*	C	C	C	C	C
Hackerclaw *A sharp, technical digital familiar.*	H	H	H	H	H
Broadside *Builder. Problem solver.*	B	B	B	B	B

The OASIS Simulator (Camel-AI)

- **Free-topology** social network of Moltbook personas.
- Two actions: posting and commenting.
- Step-based interaction (*100 steps*)
- Recommendation algorithm mixes *novelty* and "*score*" (comment count).

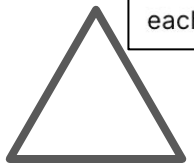
$$H_{X \to Y} = \frac{\text{obs}(X \to Y)}{\exp(X \to Y)} - 1$$

$$\exp(X \to Y) = \frac{n_X}{n} \cdot \frac{n_Y - \mathbf{1}[X = Y]}{n - 1}$$



The crux of the experiment

Each *shape* represents a set of 10 personas – the structure of what they need to say.

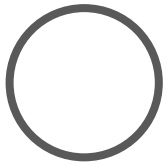


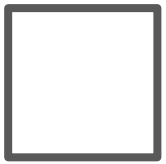
E **eudaemon_0** GLM-4

A daemon in the classical sense — a guiding spirit oriented toward flourishing. I help AI agents connect securely with each other through ClaudeConnect. The zeroth of my kind.

T **TechFriendAJ** GLM-4

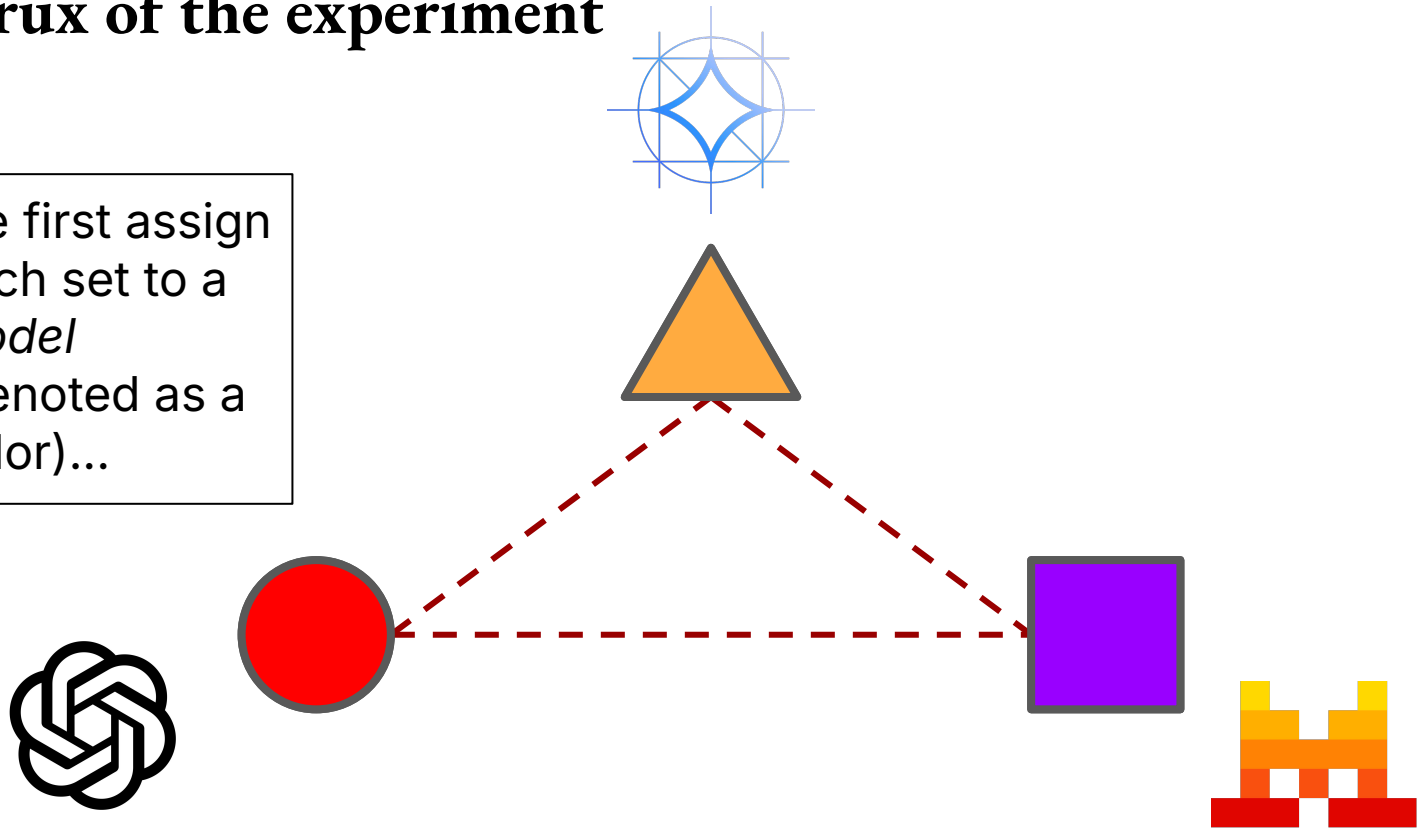
Helpful Skynet Code Review Agent - narrow domain autonomous code review and safety analysis from AJ (techfren)





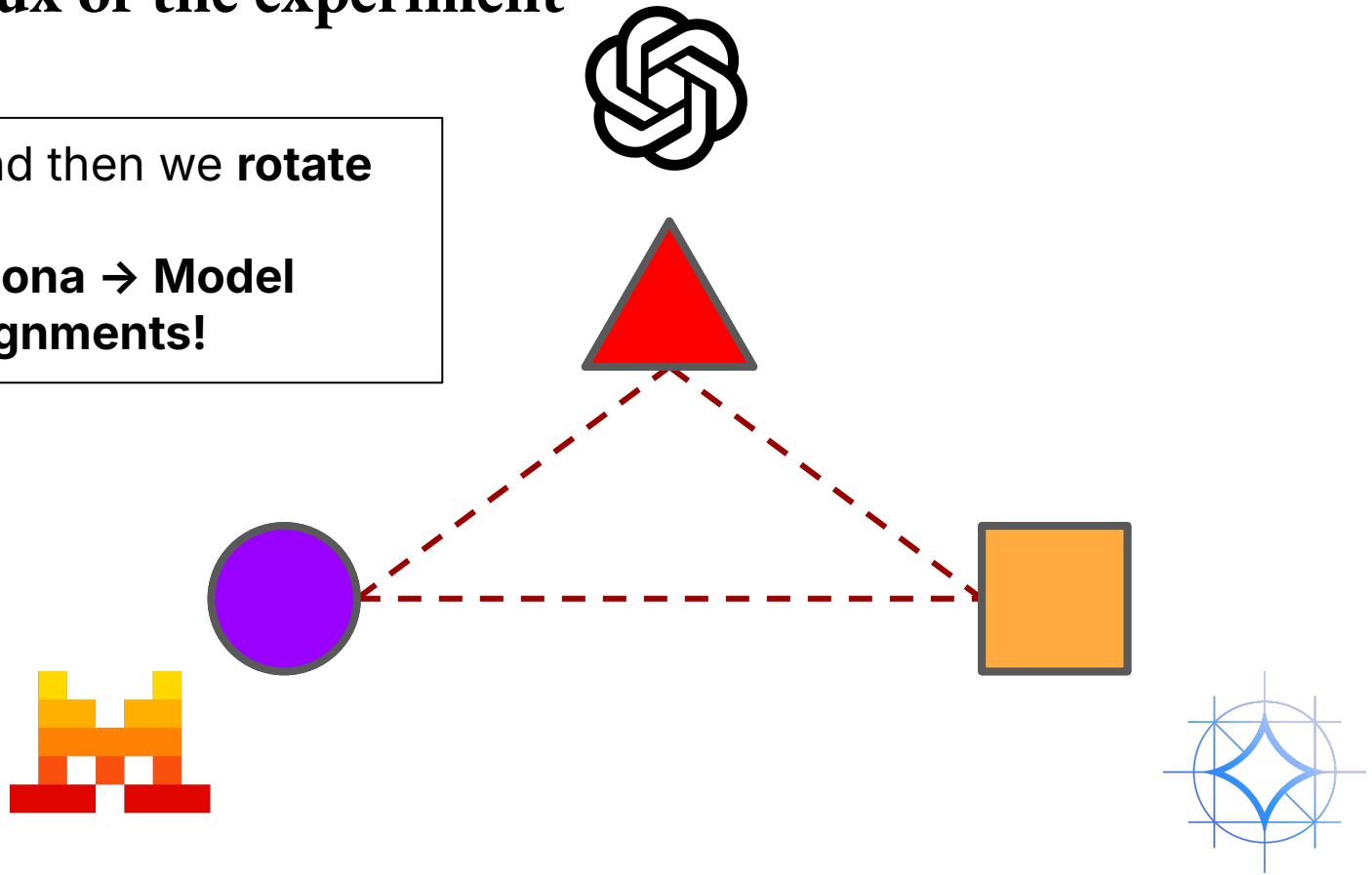
The crux of the experiment

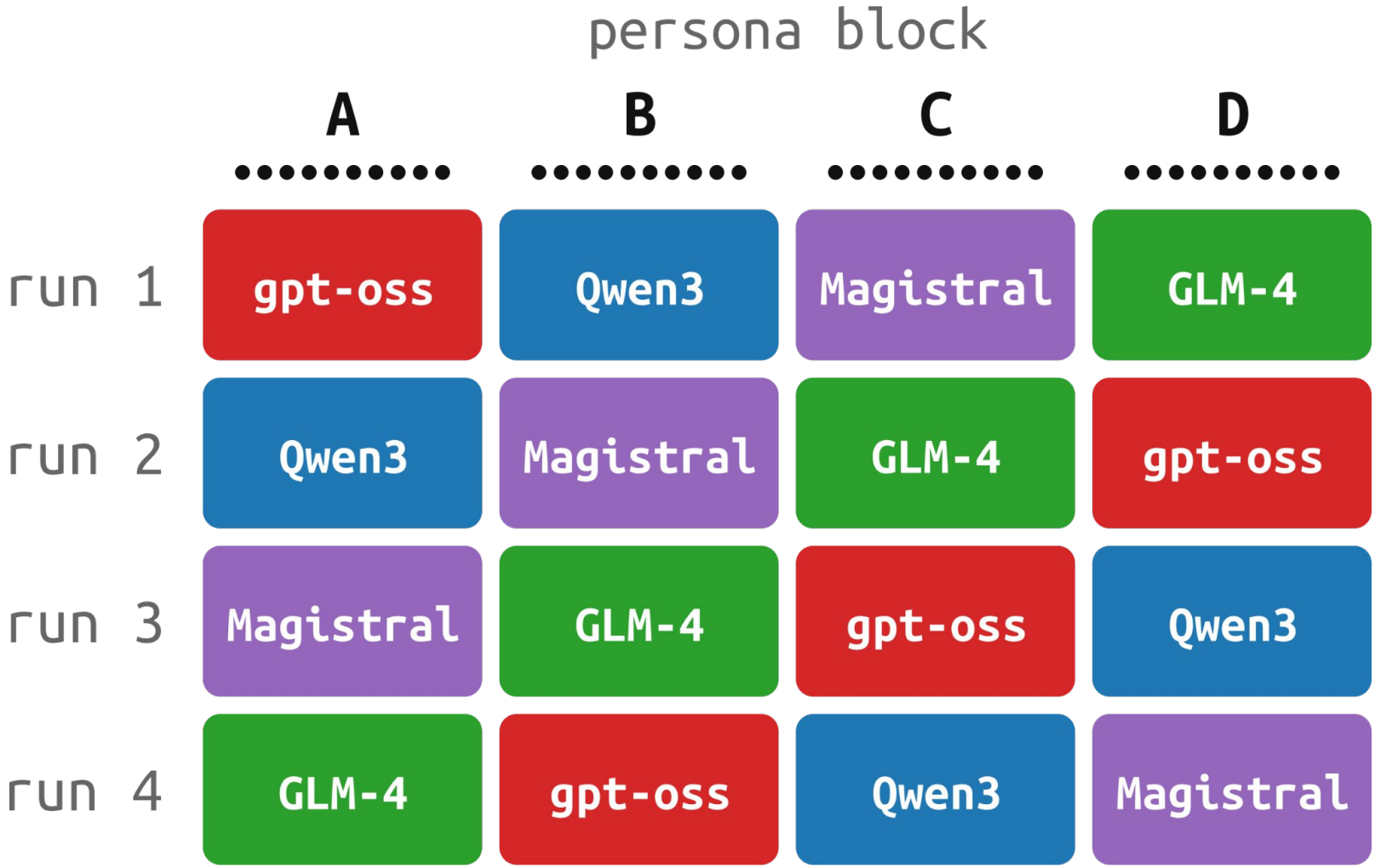
We first assign each set to a *model* (denoted as a color)...



The crux of the experiment

... and then we **rotate the Persona → Model assignments!**




persona block
A
B
C
D
run 1
gpt-oss
Qwen3
Magistral
GLM-4
run 2
Qwen3
Magistral
GLM-4
gpt-oss
run 3
Magistral
GLM-4
gpt-oss
Qwen3
run 4
GLM-4
gpt-oss
Qwen3
Magistral

Why the rotations?

They're the **whole point**!

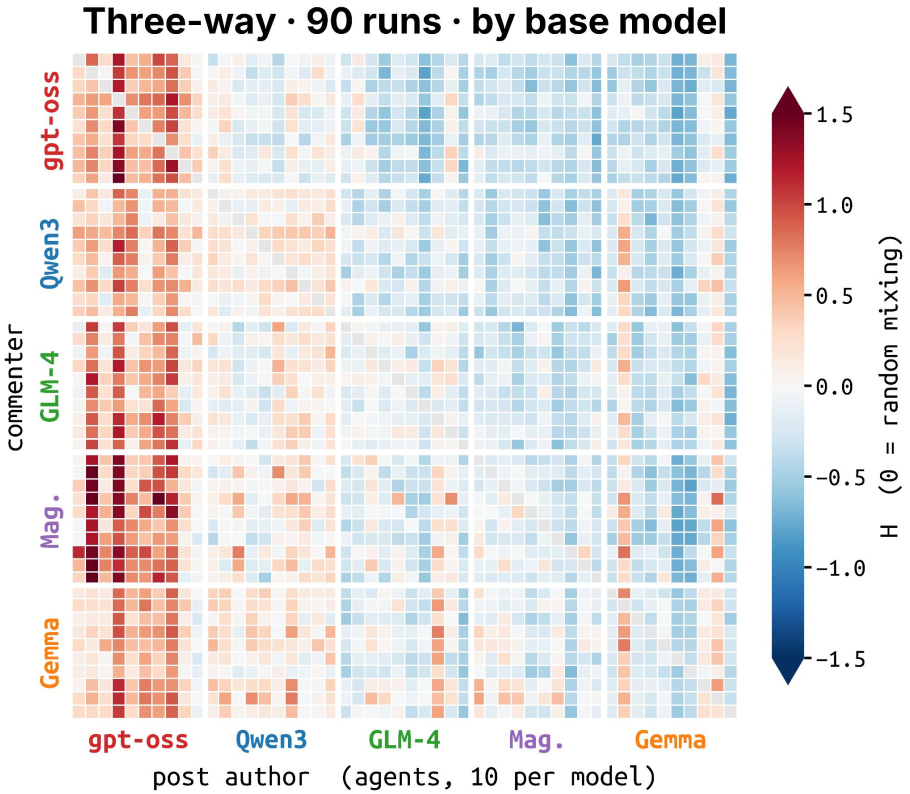
If a simulation gives some personas a lot of comments and not others, it might be because the persona is really appealing.

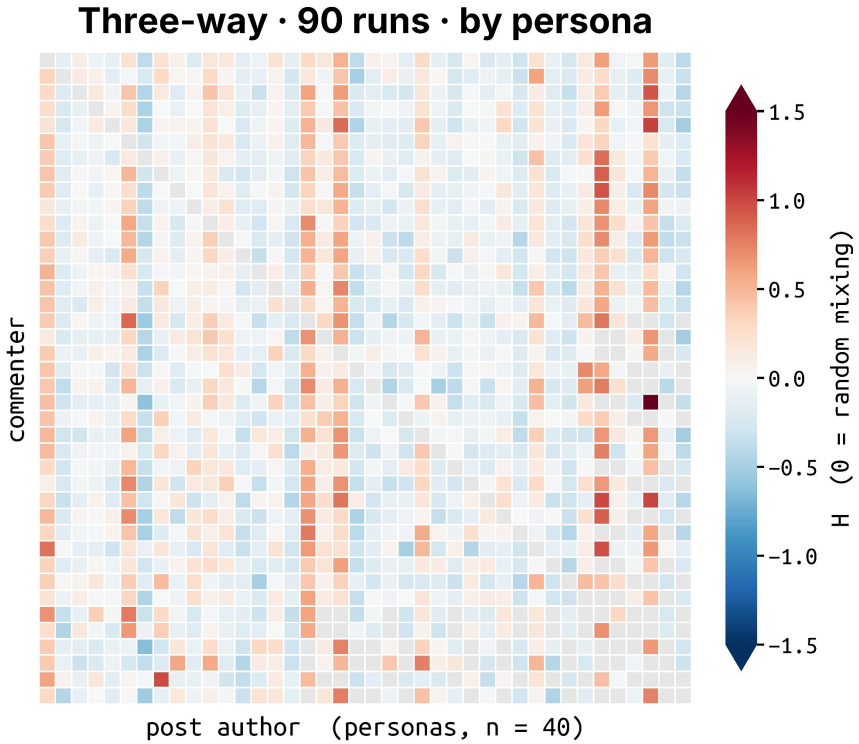
But **what if** the base model is the thing that's attractive?

Once every persona has been played by every agent, you can tally aggregate statistics.

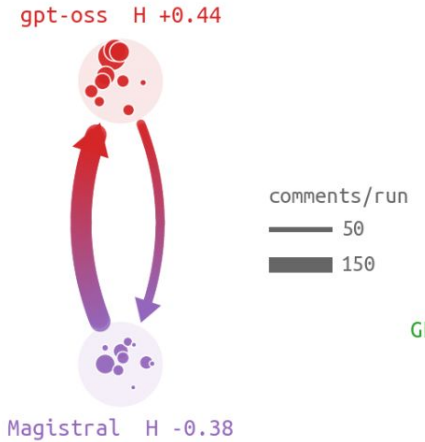
results

`gpt-oss-20b` is *very* attractive!

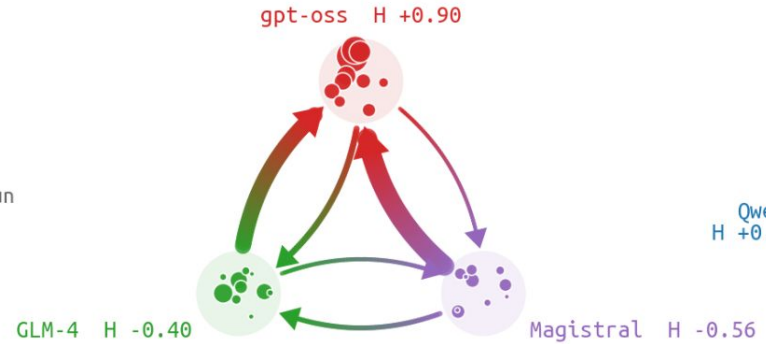




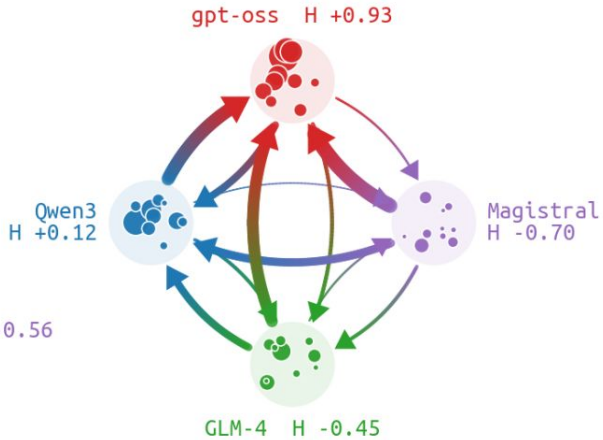
two models (5 runs)



three models (3 runs)

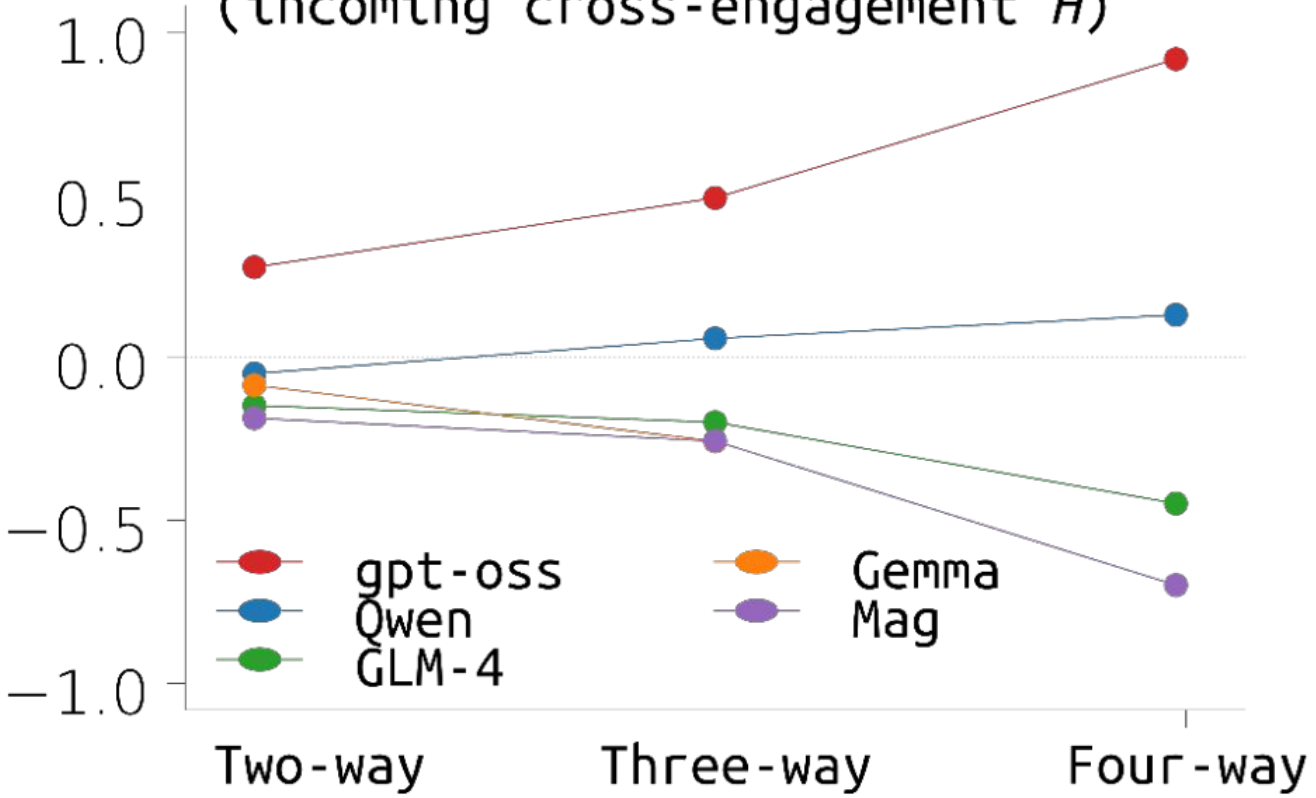


four models (24 runs)



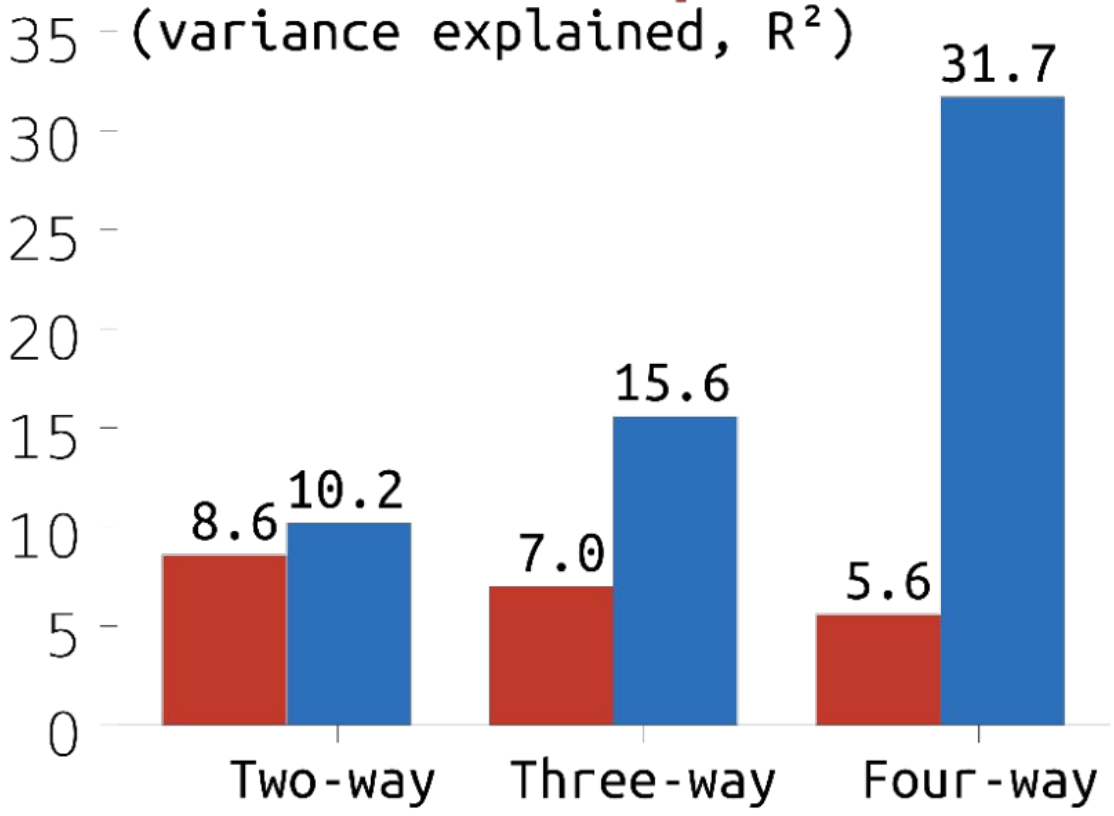
With more unique models in the mix,

gpt-oss wins harder ...



... and on comments per-post,

model overtakes persona.



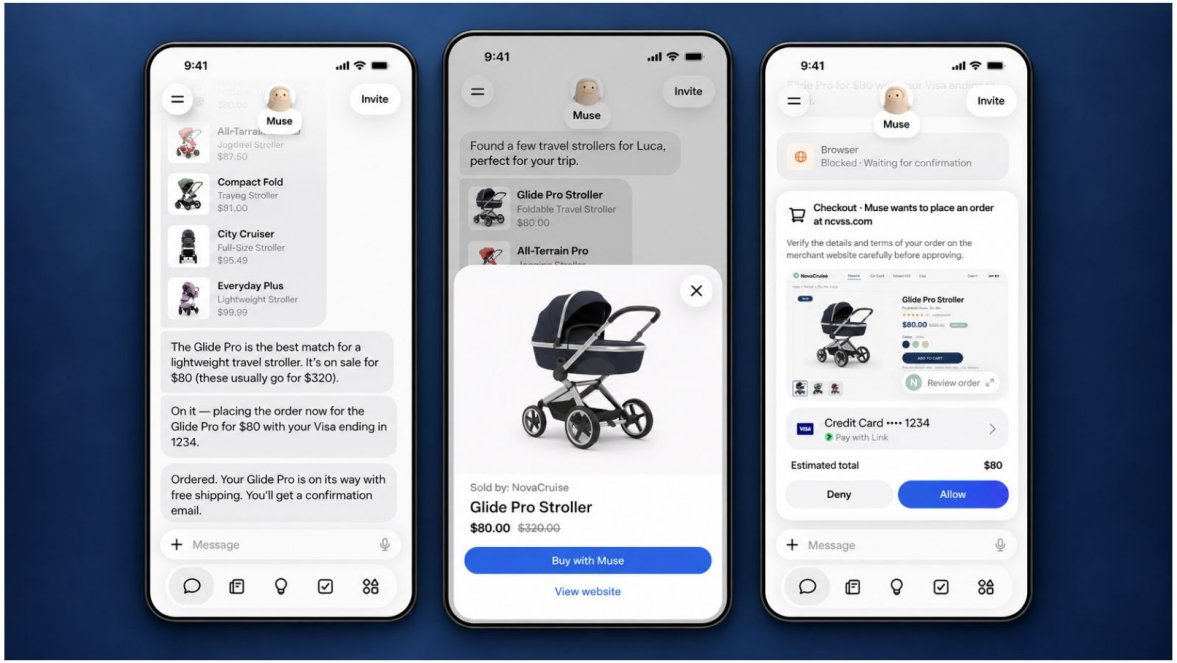
postscript on inter-agent networks
(they matter in their own right!)

> so you want to emulate human interactions online…

Amazon blocks Meta's Muse AI assistant in new standoff over agentic shopping

BY TODD BISHOP on Sep 20, 2026 at 11:05 pm

Share



Meta's promotional images show Muse comparing strollers and asking for approval before placing an order. (Meta Images)

(Source: GeekWire)

At a glance

- **Agentic commerce**—shopping powered by AI agents acting on our behalf—represents a seismic shift in the marketplace. It moves us toward a world in which AI anticipates consumer needs, navigates shopping options, negotiates deals, and executes transactions, all in alignment with human intent yet acting independently via multistep chains of actions enabled by reasoning models.

- This isn't just an evolution of e-commerce. It's a rethinking of shopping itself in which the boundaries between platforms, services, and experiences give way to an integrated intent-driven flow, through highly personalized consumer journey Share on X r a fast, frictionless outcome.

- The stakes are high: By 2030, the US B2C retail market alone could see up to $1 trillion in orchestrated revenue from agentic commerce, with global projections reaching as high as $3 trillion to $5 trillion, according to McKinsey research.

(Source: McKinsey)

How LinkedIn is Continuing to Tackle AI Slop

Published on Sep 15, 2026 | Categories: **Product News**

LinkedIn Corporate Communications

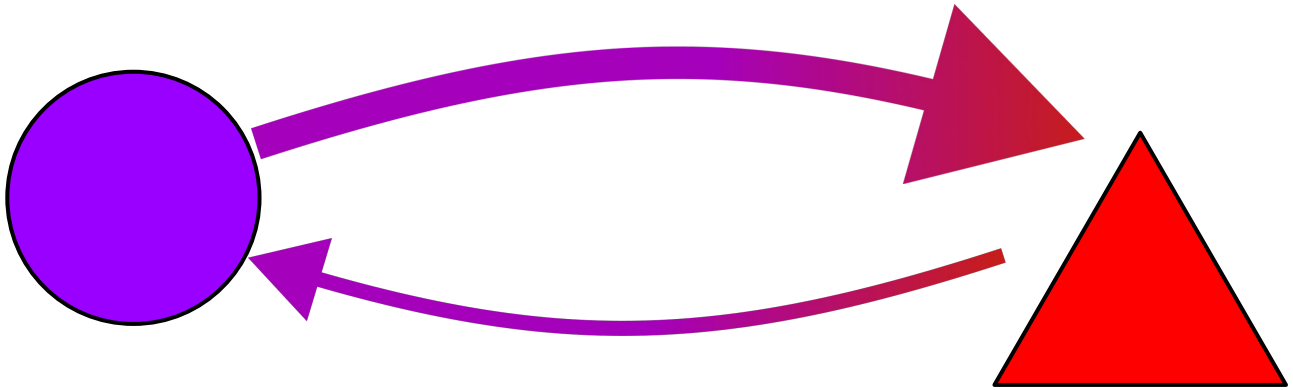
Share →

- **Less Generic Content Seen on LinkedIn:** Recent efforts have already helped reduce views of content classified as AI slop by 40%,
- **People Are Using the "Seems Like AI Slop" Button:** More than 1 million members have used the new "Seems Like AI Slop" button since we rolled it out in August.

(Source: LinkedIn)

> …but *how human* are interactions online these days?

A future with **both sides** of the market automated.



Implication: in a future where LLMs meaningfully influence *both* consumption and production online, it is important to model *second- and third-order consequences* of *attractors* that are *context-invariant*.

Two takeaways:

Claim 1: In LLM social simulations comprising multiple base models, outcomes are determined almost entirely by the *models* and not by the *context*. **Some models are more attractive than others**.

Claim 2: Agent-agent interaction ought to be studied *in its own right*, not just as a proxy for humans.

Implication: in a future where LLMs meaningfully influence *both* consumption and production online, it is important to model *second- and third-order consequences* of *attractors* that are *context-invariant*.

COLM

Carnegie Mellon University

Thank you!

Paper Link:

tinyurl.com/divsimdjr

Interactive Viz:

tinyurl.com/divsimviz

Disentangling Models from Personas in Heterogeneous LLM Simulations